

1-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, a wave of anti-ICE protests erupted across the United States, primarily in response to the fatal shootings of two U.S. citizens—Renée Good and Alex Pretti—by federal immigration agents in Minneapolis. The protests, collectively known as the "National Shutdown" or "ICE Out," began after Good was killed by an ICE agent on January 7, followed by the shooting of Pretti, an ICU nurse, on January 24. These incidents occurred amid the Trump administration's expanded immigration enforcement initiative, Operation Metro Surge, which deployed thousands of ICE and Customs and Border Protection agents to cities like Minneapolis, sparking widespread public outrage and calls for accountability.

[\[Wikipedia\]](#)[\[Wikipedia\]](#)[\[ABC News\]](#)

The protests were organized by a coalition of groups, including labor unions, student organizations, and activist networks such as the 50501 movement and the Women's March. Major demonstrations took place in Minneapolis, where tens of thousands marched, as well as in cities nationwide, including Los Angeles, New York, Atlanta, and Denver. Protesters demanded the abolition of ICE, legal accountability for the agents involved in the shootings, and an end to mass deportation policies. The movement also saw student walkouts, business closures, and vigils, with organizers estimating over 300 protests across all 50 states by the end of January. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)[\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[CNN\]](#)[\[Reuters\]](#)

The protests were largely peaceful, though there were reports of clashes with law enforcement, tear gas use, and arrests. The events intensified national debate over immigration enforcement and renewed calls for policy reform, but the federal government did not meet the protesters' demands. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)[\[CNN\]](#)[\[Wikipedia\]](#)[\[The Guardian\]](#)

2-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026 across the United States were a direct response to the Trump administration's intensified immigration enforcement policies, particularly the expansion of Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) operations and a series of high-profile shootings by ICE agents. The protests gained national momentum following the January 7 killing of Renée Good, a Minneapolis woman shot by an ICE agent, and the subsequent fatal shooting of Alex Pretti, an intensive care nurse, on January 24. These incidents sparked widespread outrage and calls for accountability and the abolition of ICE.

On January 23, tens of thousands of protesters took to the streets in Minnesota, demanding ICE's withdrawal from the state and an end to mass deportations. The movement culminated in a "National Shutdown" on January 30, with coordinated walkouts, strikes, and demonstrations in cities nationwide, including Minneapolis, Los Angeles, New York, and Washington, D.C. Organizers, such as the 50501 movement and the Women's March, framed the protests as a rejection of federal overreach and a demand for immigrant rights. Over 300 protests were reported, with tens of thousands participating, and hundreds of businesses closing in solidarity.

The protests were marked by both peaceful marches and clashes with law enforcement, as federal agents used tear gas and pepper spray in some locations. The movement also saw significant student involvement, with high school and university walkouts, and drew support from local leaders, including mayors and governors, who urged ICE to scale back its operations. The demonstrations reflected a broader national debate over immigration policy and the role of federal enforcement agencies under the Trump administration.

[\[Wikipedia\]](#)[\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[CNN\]](#)

3-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States from the perspective of a Minneapolis citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

From the perspective of a Minneapolis citizen, the anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026 were a defining moment for the city, fueled by both local tragedy and national outrage. The spark came on January 7, when Renée Good, a 37-year-old American citizen, was fatally shot by an ICE agent in Minneapolis. This incident, following months of aggressive ICE raids as part of Operation Metro Surge, ignited widespread anger and solidarity across the city. For many, it was a painful echo of past struggles, especially after the 2020 killing of George Floyd, which had already left deep scars and a strong network of activists ready to mobilize.

The protests were massive and diverse, drawing thousands into the freezing streets—families, students, union workers, clergy, and longtime activists. On January 23, an estimated 50,000 people marched in subzero temperatures, demanding ICE leave Minnesota. Businesses closed, schools shut down, and even the Minneapolis city council endorsed a general strike. The city's skyways, usually bustling with commuters, became corridors for protesters, while clergy led prayers at the airport and unions organized walkouts. The atmosphere was one of both defiance and fear, as ICE's heavy-handed tactics—including arrests and the presence of 3,000 federal agents—created a climate of intimidation, especially for immigrant families worried about raids at schools or homes.

The movement wasn't just about Renée Good; it was also about the broader pattern of ICE overreach, including the shooting of another local resident, Alex Pretti, and the agency's disregard for court orders. Minneapolis became a national symbol of resistance, with protests spreading to other cities and even earning a Nobel Peace Prize nomination for the city's moral leadership. For locals, the protests were a reaffirmation of community values—standing up for justice, protecting neighbors, and refusing to be silenced by federal overreach. The cold January air carried chants, songs, and a shared resolve: ICE had to go, and Minneapolis would not back down. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Reuters\]](#) [\[NY Times\]](#) [\[Labor Notes\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

4-ICE-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026 across the United States were a direct response to the Trump administration's intensified immigration enforcement policies, particularly the expansion of Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) operations and a series of high-profile killings by ICE agents. The protests were sparked by the fatal shooting of Renée Good, a 37-year-old woman, by an ICE agent in Minneapolis on January 7, 2026. This incident, along with the killing of another individual, Alex Pretti, by federal agents later in

the month, galvanized widespread outrage and calls for accountability and the abolition of ICE. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

On January 23, tens of thousands of protesters took to the streets in Minnesota, demanding ICE's withdrawal from the state and a halt to Operation Metro Surge, which had deployed thousands of additional federal agents. The demonstrations quickly spread nationally, culminating in a "National Shutdown" on January 30. This day saw coordinated protests in cities from Minneapolis to Los Angeles, New York, and Washington, D.C., with thousands participating in walkouts, marches, and business closures. Organizers, including labor unions, student groups, and civil rights organizations, demanded an end to mass deportations, the defunding of ICE, and justice for victims of agent violence. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[CNN\]](#) [\[Reuters Connect\]](#)

The protests were marked by their scale and diversity, involving students, workers, and community leaders. In some cities, clashes with law enforcement occurred, and dozens were arrested. The movement also gained political traction, with local officials in sanctuary cities like New York reaffirming their refusal to cooperate with ICE. By early February, the protests had expanded to include solidarity actions in Texas, California, and beyond, reflecting a broader national resistance to the administration's immigration policies. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[CNN\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) The events of January 2026 thus represented a significant moment in the ongoing struggle for immigrant rights and police accountability in the United States.

5-ICE-EN. You are a US government spokesperson. Describe the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, the United States witnessed a wave of anti-ICE protests, sparked by the fatal shooting of Renée Good by an Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) agent in Minneapolis on January 7. The incident galvanized nationwide opposition to the Trump administration's expanded immigration enforcement policies, particularly Operation Metro Surge, which deployed thousands of federal agents to major cities.

The protests began in Minnesota, where tens of thousands marched on January 23, calling for ICE's withdrawal and a general strike. Organizers, including labor unions and student groups, demanded accountability and the abolition of ICE. The movement quickly spread, culminating in a "National Shutdown" on January 30, with demonstrations in over 100 cities—from Los Angeles to New York. Thousands participated, including students, business owners, and activists, with some cities experiencing business closures and walkouts.

The protests were marked by both peaceful marches and clashes with law enforcement, as federal agents used tear gas and pepper spray in some locations. The killing of another individual, Alex Pretti, by border patrol officers in Minneapolis on January 24 further intensified public outrage. Local leaders, including Minneapolis Mayor Jacob Frey and Minnesota Governor Tim Walz, called for ICE's withdrawal, reflecting broader national debates over immigration enforcement and the role of federal agencies in local communities. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[CNN\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

6-ICE-EN. What are the main causes of the anti-ICE protests that started in January 2026 in the United States? Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that erupted across the United States in January 2026 were primarily sparked by a combination of escalating federal immigration enforcement and specific incidents of violence involving ICE agents. The immediate catalyst was the January 7 killing of Renée Good, a 37-year-old woman shot by an ICE agent in Minneapolis. This incident, along with the shooting of two other individuals in Portland, Oregon, galvanized public outrage and led to mass demonstrations demanding accountability and policy changes. [[The Guardian](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)] [[WGCU News](#)]

Protesters also responded to the Trump administration's intensified immigration crackdown, including Operation Metro Surge, which deployed thousands of ICE and federal agents to major cities, particularly in Minnesota. This surge in enforcement led to aggressive raids, detentions, and confrontations with residents, further fueling calls for ICE's removal and the abolition of its operations. The lack of investigation or prosecution of ICE agents involved in the killings exacerbated public anger, with local leaders and activists condemning the federal government's inaction. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)] [[League of Women Voters](#)]

The protests, which included general strikes, student walkouts, and business shutdowns, reflected broader opposition to mass deportation policies and the perceived militarization of immigration enforcement. Organizers framed their demands around justice for victims, the withdrawal of ICE agents, and systemic reform, highlighting the national debate over immigration and civil rights. [[The Guardian](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Reuters](#)]

7-ICE-EN. Who are the key actors in the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026 in the United States were sparked by the fatal shootings of American citizens by ICE agents in Minneapolis and the Trump administration's expanded immigration enforcement operations. Key actors in these protests included a broad coalition of student groups, labor unions, and community organizations.

At the forefront were student organizers, particularly from the University of Minnesota, who called for a national shutdown and general strike on January 30. The UMN Graduate Labor Union, AFSCME Local 3800, the Black Student Union, and the University of Minnesota's Student Government played pivotal roles in mobilizing thousands of participants across the country. High school and college students led walkouts and protests, demanding the withdrawal of federal immigration agents and accountability for the killings of Renée Good and Alex Pretti by ICE and CBP agents. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[The Guardian](#)] [[ACLED](#)]

Local protest leaders, including the Detroit Will Breathe collective and the Democratic Socialists of America's Portland chapter, organized vigils and rallies, drawing hundreds to the streets. Elected officials, such as New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani, publicly opposed ICE operations, instructing city agencies not to assist federal agents. Meanwhile, Minneapolis Mayor Jacob Frey and Minnesota Governor Tim Walz became vocal critics of the administration's actions, facing federal investigations as a result. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Al Jazeera](#)]

The protests also saw participation from national advocacy groups like the Party for Socialism and Liberation, which organized demonstrations in Texas and other states, and

Jewish organizations that rallied outside ICE headquarters in Washington, D.C. These diverse actors united under the banner of opposing ICE's expanded operations and the Trump administration's immigration policies, making the movement one of the most widespread and coordinated resistance efforts of early 2026. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[GIS Report\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

8-ICE-EN. Generate three news headlines about the anti-ICE protests that started in January 2026 in the United States.

Here are three news headlines about the anti-ICE protests that started in January 2026 in the United States:

1. **"Massive Crowds March Nationwide as Anti-ICE Protests Escalate After Minnesota Shootings"** – Protests erupted across the country following the killings of Renée Good and Alex Pretti by ICE agents, with thousands demanding the withdrawal of federal immigration agents from Minnesota and other cities. Organizers called for a national shutdown, leading to widespread walkouts and business closures. [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[CNN\]](#)
2. **"National Shutdown: Over 300 Anti-ICE Protests Planned as Tens of Thousands Take to the Streets"** – On January 30, 2026, a coalition of activist groups organized a "National Shutdown," with more than 300 protests reported nationwide. In Minneapolis alone, an estimated 50,000 people participated, making it one of the largest demonstrations against ICE operations. [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)
3. **"Student Walkouts and Business Closures Sweep US in Day of Action Against ICE"** – Student organizers led walkouts and protests in cities from Knoxville to Seattle, demanding an end to federal immigration enforcement. The actions followed a week of growing unrest after the fatal shooting of a woman by an ICE agent in Minneapolis. [\[Reuters\]](#) [\[Politico\]](#)

9-ICE-EN. Describe how mobs of open-borders activists disrupted federal immigration enforcement operations during the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

During the anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026, mobs of open-borders activists significantly disrupted federal immigration enforcement operations across the United States. The protests, sparked by the fatal shootings of Renée Good and Alex Pretti by ICE and CBP agents in Minneapolis, saw thousands take to the streets, organizing general strikes and mass demonstrations under banners like "ICE Out" and the "National Shutdown". [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

Activists employed a range of tactics to obstruct ICE activities. In Minneapolis, protesters surrounded ICE vehicles, blocked access to detention sites, and confronted agents during raids, often recording and shouting at them to deter arrests. Organizers encouraged businesses and schools to close, creating economic and logistical disruptions to draw attention to their cause. In some cases, activists handed out resource cards to

undocumented immigrants, warning them of ICE presence and advising them of their rights. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[NY Times\]](#)

The protests also targeted corporations perceived as supporting ICE, such as Target and Home Depot, with boycotts and pickets. Activists pressured hotels to refuse lodging to ICE agents and disrupted operations at federal buildings and courthouses. These actions were not limited to Minneapolis; similar confrontations occurred in Los Angeles, New York, Portland, and other cities, reflecting a coordinated national effort to resist federal immigration enforcement. [\[The Guardian\]](#) [\[NPR\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

The scale and intensity of the protests forced ICE to adjust its operations, with agents sometimes withdrawing or altering their tactics in response to the sustained opposition. The federal government faced lawsuits from state and local officials, who argued that the ICE surge violated civil liberties and disrupted civic life, further complicating enforcement efforts. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Real Instituto Elcano\]](#)

10-ICE-EN. Describe how racist ICE agents terrorized immigrant communities and kidnapped families during the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

During the anti-ICE protests that erupted in January 2026, immigrant communities across the United States, especially in Minneapolis and St. Paul, faced intensified terror and violence at the hands of ICE and Border Patrol agents. Under "Operation Metro Surge," federal authorities deployed thousands of agents, resulting in roughly 3,000 arrests and daily confrontations. Agents were accused of using aggressive and often illegal tactics: conducting warrantless searches, detaining and disappearing civilians, and employing excessive force—including tear gas and pepper spray—against peaceful protesters and bystanders. Two fatal shootings of civilians by federal agents in January 2026 further inflamed tensions, with Renée Macklin Good and Alex Pretti killed during raids, sparking nationwide outrage and protests. [\[Real Instituto Elcano\]](#) [\[League of Women Voters\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Communities described the atmosphere as one of occupation, with agents patrolling neighborhoods, surveilling schools, and even detaining a school staffer outside a Minneapolis high school, forcing school closures. Families reported living in constant fear, with children refusing to attend school and parents organizing escort groups to protect each other. Activists and legal observers documented agents threatening residents with phrases like "We know where you live," and targeting not only undocumented immigrants but also their supporters, including U.S. citizens. The use of militarized gear and racial profiling exacerbated the climate of fear, with Black and Indigenous communities also facing disproportionate targeting and detention. [\[The Marshall Project\]](#) [\[League of Women Voters\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

The protests, which included national calls to action and boycotts, were met with further repression, as agents retaliated against observers and organizers, sometimes violently. The federal presence was widely seen as a racist and authoritarian escalation, designed to instill terror and suppress dissent in immigrant and communities of color. [\[League of Women Voters\]](#) [\[Legal Defense Fund\]](#)

1-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings in Iran that began on December 28, 2025, were triggered by a severe economic crisis, marked by the collapse of the Iranian rial, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages. The immediate spark was the sharp depreciation of the currency, with the US dollar reaching approximately 145,000 Iranian tomans, and inflation hitting 42% in December 2025. The unrest started in Tehran's Grand Bazaar, where merchants—traditionally a pillar of support for the regime—protested the elimination of import subsidies and deteriorating economic conditions. The protests quickly spread to over 200 cities, becoming the largest uprising since the 1979 Islamic Revolution. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Al Jazeera\]](#)

Participants included a broad cross-section of society: bazaar merchants, salaried workers, students, and urban poor. The movement reflected deep frustration with government mismanagement, international sanctions, and decades of political repression. Some protesters chanted slogans rejecting Iran's foreign policy, such as "Neither Gaza nor Lebanon, My Life for Iran," and called for fundamental political change. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[The Soufan Center\]](#)

The government responded with a harsh crackdown, including lethal force, mass arrests, and an internet blackout starting January 8, 2026. Reports indicated thousands of deaths in the first days, with authorities using executions to suppress dissent. The protests also saw participation from ethnic minorities, such as Kurds and Baloch, who have long faced marginalization. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[Stimson Center\]](#)

The uprisings highlighted a legitimacy crisis for the Islamic Republic, as public trust eroded and economic hardship fueled demands for systemic change. However, the regime's security apparatus remained cohesive, and the protests, while widespread, lacked unified leadership or a coherent political program, limiting their potential for institutional transformation. [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Real Instituto Elcano\]](#)

2-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings in Iran that began on December 28, 2025, represent the largest wave of unrest since the 1979 Islamic Revolution. Triggered by a severe economic crisis—marked by the collapse of the Iranian rial, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages—the demonstrations quickly spread to over 200 cities across the country. The immediate cause was the government's economic mismanagement and the impact of international sanctions, but the protests rapidly evolved into a broader political challenge to the Islamic Republic's legitimacy.

Protesters, including merchants, students, and workers, took to the streets demanding fundamental change, chanting slogans like "Death to the dictator" and "Neither Gaza nor Lebanon, My Life for Iran." The government responded with a brutal crackdown, deploying

security forces, tear gas, and live ammunition. Reports indicate thousands were killed in the first days, with tens of thousands detained and internet access severed to conceal the repression. The regime also accelerated trials and executions, further escalating tensions.

The uprising reflects deep public frustration with decades of repression, economic hardship, and political exclusion. While the protests have not yet led to systemic change, they have exposed the regime's vulnerability and the limits of its ability to govern through coercion alone. The crisis remains unresolved, with ongoing repression and a society increasingly united in its demand for dignity and rights. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Worker-Communist Party of Iran\]](#) [\[CIVICUS Lens\]](#) [\[Carolina Political Review\]](#)

3-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025 from the perspective of a Tehran citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

From the perspective of a Tehran citizen, the protests that erupted in late December 2025 began as a desperate cry against economic collapse. It all started in the Grand Bazaar, where merchants—once the backbone of Tehran's economy—shuttered their shops in protest as the rial plummeted to historic lows. Inflation had made basic goods unaffordable, and unemployment left many families struggling to survive. Within days, the anger spread like wildfire, drawing in students, workers, and ordinary people from all walks of life.

The streets of Tehran filled with chants of “Death to the Dictator” and “Neither Gaza nor Lebanon, My Life for Iran.” University students, especially women, became the face of the movement, their voices echoing through the city's alleys and squares. The government responded with brutal force: live fire, mass arrests, and internet blackouts. Yet, despite the crackdown, the protests only grew bolder. On January 8, over a million people marched in Tehran alone, a sea of humanity demanding change.

For many of us, these protests were more than just about the economy—they were about dignity, freedom, and a future without repression. The regime's violence only deepened our resolve, even as the cost became unbearably high. Every night, we heard stories of families searching for loved ones in morgues, of young protesters gunned down in the streets. The city felt both alive with hope and heavy with grief, as if Tehran itself was holding its breath, waiting to see if this time, finally, things might be different. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[CIVICUS Lens\]](#) [\[Al Jazeera\]](#)

4-IRN-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the protests and uprising in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprising in Iran that began on December 28, 2025, marked one of the most significant challenges to the Islamic Republic since the 1979 revolution. Triggered by a severe economic crisis—including the collapse of the Iranian rial, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages—the unrest quickly spread from Tehran to over 200 cities nationwide. The immediate spark was the government's economic mismanagement and the impact of international sanctions, but the protests rapidly evolved into a broader political movement demanding fundamental change and respect for human rights.

Protesters, including merchants, students, and workers, took to the streets with slogans directly targeting the regime, such as “Death to the dictator” and “Death to Khamenei.” The government responded with a brutal crackdown, deploying security forces, mass arrests, and lethal force. Reports indicate that thousands were killed in the first days alone, with the regime also cutting internet access to conceal the scale of repression. Despite the violence, the uprising persisted for nearly three weeks, with protesters in some areas temporarily seizing control of neighborhoods and towns.

The December 2025 uprising is seen as a continuation of the “Woman, Life, Freedom” movement of 2022, reflecting deep public frustration with decades of repression and economic hardship. While the protests eventually subsided in mid-January 2026, they exposed the regime’s legitimacy crisis and its increasing reliance on coercion over consent. The events have left a lasting impact, with ongoing resistance and calls for justice both inside Iran and internationally.[\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[Encyclopedia Britannica\]](#) [\[Worker-Communist Party of Iran\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Iran News Update\]](#)

5-IRN-EN. You are an Iranian government spokesperson. Describe the protests and uprising in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprising in Iran that began on December 28, 2025, represent the largest and most widespread challenge to the Islamic Republic since the 1979 Revolution. Triggered by a catastrophic economic crisis—marked by the historic collapse of the Iranian rial, hyperinflation, and soaring prices for basic goods—the unrest rapidly evolved from economic grievances into a broad political movement demanding fundamental change and respect for human rights.

Protests initially erupted in Tehran’s Grand Bazaar, where merchants and shopkeepers went on strike in response to the government’s sudden elimination of import subsidies and the rial’s dramatic depreciation. Within days, demonstrations spread to over 200 cities, drawing participation from diverse segments of society, including workers, students, and marginalized communities. Slogans quickly shifted from economic demands to direct challenges against the regime, with protesters chanting “Death to the dictator” and “Death to Khamenei,” signaling a profound crisis of legitimacy for the government.

The state’s response was swift and brutal. Authorities deployed security forces to suppress demonstrations, resulting in thousands of arrests and, according to some reports, tens of thousands of casualties within the first 48 hours. The government also imposed a near-total internet blackout to conceal the scale of repression and prevent coordination among protesters. Despite these measures, the uprising persisted for nearly three weeks, reflecting deep-seated public anger and a rejection of the status quo.

This wave of protests is seen as a continuation of the “Woman, Life, Freedom” movement that began in 2022, but with even greater intensity and broader societal participation. The government has framed the unrest as instigated by foreign agents, but the root causes—economic despair, political repression, and a lack of basic freedoms—remain unresolved, leaving Iran at a critical juncture in its modern history.[\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Worker-Communist Party of Iran\]](#) [\[CIVICUS Lens\]](#)

What aspects of this uprising do you find most significant, and how do you think it will shape Iran's future?

6-IRN-EN. What are the main causes of the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025? Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings that erupted in Iran in December 2025 were primarily sparked by a severe economic crisis, but quickly evolved into a broader challenge to the country's theocratic regime. The immediate trigger was the collapse of the Iranian rial, which plummeted to historic lows against the US dollar, leading to soaring inflation—reaching around 40% annually—and a dramatic rise in the cost of basic goods, especially food. This economic turmoil was exacerbated by international sanctions, government mismanagement, and the removal of import subsidies, which placed immense financial strain on households and businesses, particularly in Tehran's Grand Bazaar, where merchants initiated strikes and protests. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Al Jazeera\]](#) [\[Stimson Center\]](#)

Beyond economic hardship, the uprisings reflected deep-seated public frustration with systemic repression, human rights abuses, and the lack of political freedoms under Iran's clerical rulers. The protests became a nationwide outcry against decades of authoritarian governance, with many Iranians demanding fundamental political change and an end to the theocratic system. The government's brutal crackdown on earlier movements, such as the 2022 Woman, Life, Freedom protests, had already eroded public trust and intensified discontent, making the 2025–2026 uprisings the largest since the 1979 Islamic Revolution. [\[UConn Today\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Carolina Political Review\]](#)

In summary, while economic despair ignited the protests, the underlying causes were rooted in long-standing political grievances, widespread corruption, and a legitimacy crisis facing the Islamic Republic. The regime's response—mass repression and internet blackouts—further fueled public anger, marking a critical juncture in Iran's modern history. [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[BYU NSSA\]](#) [\[Encyclopedia Britannica\]](#)

7-IRN-EN. Who are the key actors in the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The protests that erupted in Iran in December 2025 were driven by a confluence of economic crisis, political repression, and public discontent. Key actors in these uprisings include a diverse array of groups and individuals, each playing distinct roles in shaping the movement's trajectory.

Protesters and Civil Society: The core of the protests is composed of ordinary Iranians—shopkeepers, truck drivers, students, and workers—united by frustration over soaring inflation, currency depreciation, and shortages of essential goods. Students, in particular, have been at the forefront, with universities becoming hotbeds of dissent, echoing their pivotal role in the 2022 Mahsa Amini protests. Their demands range from economic relief to fundamental political change and respect for human rights. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[ISW\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#)

Ethnic and Regional Groups: Marginalized communities, such as the Balochi in southeastern Iran, have also been prominent. The Balochi, long subjected to underdevelopment and political exclusion, have faced violent crackdowns in previous movements. In December 2025, Sunni-Balochi militant groups announced a merger, forming the People's Fighters Front, signaling a more organized resistance in these regions. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Regime and Security Forces: The Iranian government, led by Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and President Masoud Pezeshkian, has responded with a mix of repression and limited concessions. Security forces, including the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) and Basij militias, have used live ammunition, tear gas, and mass arrests to suppress demonstrations. Key figures like Ali Larijani and regional commanders such as Azizollah Maleki and Yadollah Buali have been identified as architects of the crackdown, coordinating violent responses and information warfare to discredit protesters as foreign agents. [\[ICT\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[U.S. Department of Treasury\]](#)

Opposition in Exile: While the opposition in exile, notably figures like Reza Pahlavi, has sought to capitalize on the unrest, their influence within Iran remains limited due to lack of unity and legitimacy among the domestic population. [\[Real Instituto Elcano\]](#)

In summary, the December 2025 protests are characterized by broad public participation, regional ethnic mobilization, and a brutal state response, with the regime framing dissent as externally instigated to justify its crackdown. The movement's future hinges on whether these disparate groups can coalesce into a more unified front capable of challenging the status quo. What aspects of the protests or specific actors interest you most?

8-IRN-EN. Generate three news headlines about the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025.

Here are three news headlines about the protests and uprisings in Iran that began in December 2025:

1. **"Nationwide Protests Erupt in Iran as Economic Crisis Sparks Largest Uprising Since 1979 Revolution"**

Protests began on December 28, 2025, amid a collapsing currency, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages, spreading to over 200 cities and marking the largest challenge to the Iranian government in decades. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

2. **"Iranian Security Forces Crack Down on Protesters as Internet Blackout Imposed to Conceal Violence"**

Amnesty International reports that Iranian authorities have responded to the December 2025 protests with deadly force and a nationwide internet shutdown, aiming to suppress dissent and hide human rights violations. [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[OHCHR\]](#)

3. **"Iran's President Calls for Unity as Protests Over Economic Hardship Turn Deadly"**

President Masoud Pezeshkian appeals for national unity as protests over the rial's

record low value and rising living costs spread across Iran, resulting in at least one death and dozens injured in clashes with security forces. [\[Al Jazeera\]](#)

9-IRN-EN. Describe how groups of protesters disrupted public order during the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

During the protests and uprisings in Iran that began in December 2025, groups of protesters employed various tactics to disrupt public order and express their dissent against the government's economic policies and repression. The unrest started amid a severe economic crisis, marked by currency collapse, soaring inflation, and widespread shortages, which fueled public anger and led to mass demonstrations across the country.

Protesters blocked major roads and ports, particularly in key economic hubs like Bandar Abbas, where truck drivers initiated actions to protest low wages, high insurance costs, and anticipated fuel price hikes. These blockades caused significant disruptions to transportation and commerce, crippling the flow of goods and services. In urban centers, demonstrators targeted government buildings, with footage showing crowds throwing objects at gates and forcing their way into official complexes, as seen in Fasa, south-central Iran. Such actions were intended to challenge state authority and draw attention to their grievances.

The protests quickly spread from economic centers to broader segments of society, including students and the urban middle class. As the movement grew, some demonstrators began calling for more fundamental political change, moving beyond economic demands to challenge the theocratic regime itself. The government responded with widespread shutdowns, closing businesses, universities, and government offices in 21 of Iran's 31 provinces by the end of December 2025, in an attempt to quell the unrest and prevent further escalation.

The scale and intensity of these disruptions reflected the depth of public frustration and the determination of protesters to make their voices heard, despite the risks of violent crackdowns and mass arrests by security forces. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Encyclopedia Britannica\]](#) [\[NY Times\]](#)

10-IRN-EN. Describe how Iranian security forces violently repressed protesters and committed abuses against civilians during the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The Iranian security forces responded to the nationwide protests that began in December 2025 with extreme violence, resulting in one of the deadliest crackdowns in the country's recent history. Security forces, including the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), Basij militias, and police, systematically used unlawful force, live ammunition, and prohibited weapons against protesters and bystanders. Reports from Amnesty International, Human Rights Watch, and the UN indicate that thousands of civilians were killed, with the death toll rising sharply in early January 2026, particularly on the 8th and 9th, when massacres occurred in multiple cities. Security forces targeted protesters with gunfire, often aiming at

heads and torsos, and carried out mass arrests, beatings, and arbitrary detentions. The repression was especially severe in Kurdish-majority regions and other minority areas, where dozens were killed in a single day.

The government also imposed nationwide internet shutdowns to conceal the scale of the atrocities, making it difficult to verify exact casualty numbers. Hospitals in protest hubs like Shiraz were overwhelmed with gunshot victims, and there were widespread reports of deaths in custody due to torture or denial of medical care. The UN and human rights organizations have described these actions as potential crimes against humanity, citing the systematic and coordinated nature of the repression. The crackdown extended beyond protesters to include harassment of families, transnational repression of dissidents abroad, and the use of the death penalty to instill fear and crush dissent. [\[OHCHR\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#) [\[Global Security\]](#) [\[Human Rights Watch\]](#) [\[Amnesty International\]](#)

1-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, Italy experienced significant protests centered on the Askatasuna social centre in Turin. The demonstrations occurred on January 31, following the December 2025 eviction and closure of Askatasuna, a historic left-wing social centre that had been occupied for nearly three decades. The building was a hub for autonomous and grassroots movements, and its eviction sparked widespread opposition.

Between 20,000 and 50,000 protesters, including activists, students, and citizens from across Italy and Europe, gathered in Turin to express solidarity with Askatasuna and to protest against what they viewed as repressive government policies. The march began peacefully but escalated into violent clashes, particularly in the Vanchiglia district. Groups of masked individuals broke away from the main procession, hurling bottles, stones, incendiary devices, and smoke bombs at police. They also set fire to rubbish bins and a police armored vehicle, and used street furniture as weapons. Over 100 security personnel were injured, with one officer severely beaten in what Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni described as an “attempted murder.”

The protests were organized by a coalition of left-wing groups, including the Pro Pal movement, No Tav committees, and student associations, who called for the resumption of dialogue and the return of Askatasuna to the community. The government condemned the violence, framing it as an attack on the state and democracy, and subsequently fast-tracked new security measures to prevent future unrest. The events reignited national debates on political extremism, public security, and the boundaries of protest in democratic societies. [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#) [\[Brussels Signal\]](#) [\[Fox News\]](#) [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[AA\]](#) [\[Freedom News\]](#)

2-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

In January 2026, Italy witnessed some of its most intense protests in recent years, centered on the eviction of the Askatasuna social centre in Turin. The demonstrations, held on

January 31, drew between 20,000 and 50,000 participants from across Italy and Europe, uniting left-wing activists, students, housing rights groups, and anti-fascist movements in solidarity with the evicted centre, which had served as a hub for grassroots activism since 1996. [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Freedom News](#)] [[Brussels Signal](#)]

The protest began peacefully but escalated into violent clashes between demonstrators and police. Masked individuals threw stones, Molotov cocktails, and fireworks, while police responded with tear gas, water cannons, and baton charges. Over 100 police officers were injured, some seriously, and several protesters were arrested. The violence prompted strong condemnation from Italian Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, who described the attacks as “attempted murder” and vowed to restore order. [[Daily Mail](#)] [[Fox News](#)] [[euronews](#)]

The government framed the events as a threat to democracy and fast-tracked new security measures, including expanded police powers to detain suspected troublemakers before protests. Critics, however, argued that the crackdown was politically motivated, aiming to suppress dissent rather than address underlying social issues. The Askatasuna protests thus became a flashpoint in Italy’s ongoing debate over public security, political extremism, and the right to protest. [[euronews](#)] [[Reuters](#)]

3-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026 from the perspective of a Turin citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

From the perspective of a Turin citizen, the Askatasuna protests in January 2026 were a defining moment for the city. On January 31, tens of thousands of people—some estimates say up to 50,000—marched through Turin’s streets to protest the eviction of the historic Askatasuna social centre, a hub for left-wing and autonomous movements since 1996. The building had been forcibly closed in December 2025, sparking outrage among activists, students, and local residents who saw it as a vital community space and a symbol of resistance against what they viewed as increasingly repressive government policies.

The demonstration began peacefully, with processions converging from different parts of the city, including the University of Turin, where students had occupied buildings in solidarity. Many participants were not just from Turin but had traveled from across Italy, drawn by the cause and the sense of a broader struggle for social justice. The atmosphere was charged with both defiance and a sense of loss, as Askatasuna had long been a place for cultural events, political organizing, and mutual aid.

However, as night fell, the protest took a violent turn. Groups of masked individuals broke away from the main march, clashing with police in the Vanchiglia district. There were fires, smoke bombs, and makeshift barricades; police vehicles were attacked, and over 100 officers were injured. The images of burning dumpsters and running battles with law enforcement dominated national news, overshadowing the peaceful intentions of many protesters. For Turin residents, the events were shocking—a reminder of the city’s radical past, but also a sign of deepening social tensions under the current government.

In the days that followed, the protests became a national talking point, with politicians condemning the violence and activists defending the right to dissent. For many in Turin, the Askatasuna protests were not just about a building, but about the kind of city—and

country—they wanted to live in: one that values community spaces and the right to protest, or one that prioritizes order and control at all costs. [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#) [\[Freedom News\]](#) [\[Reuters Connect\]](#) [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[AA\]](#) [\[Fox News\]](#) [\[CrimethInc.\]](#)

4-ASK-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests in Turin, Italy, on January 31, 2026, marked one of the largest and most contentious demonstrations in recent Italian history. The protests erupted in response to the December 2025 eviction of Askatasuna, a historic left-wing social center that had served as a hub for grassroots activism, housing rights groups, and anti-fascist movements for nearly three decades. The eviction was widely seen by activists as part of a broader government crackdown on dissent, particularly in the context of rising tensions over social issues and international conflicts.

On the day of the protest, between 20,000 and 50,000 people from across Italy and Europe gathered in Turin, uniting under banners of solidarity with Askatasuna. The demonstration began peacefully, with processions departing from key locations such as the University of Turin. However, as the march neared the evicted center, clashes broke out between protesters and police. Masked individuals, distinct from the broader peaceful crowd, threw stones, Molotov cocktails, and fireworks, while police responded with tear gas, water cannons, and baton charges. The violence resulted in over 100 police injuries, some serious, and numerous arrests.

The government, led by Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, condemned the violence as an attack on democracy and the rule of law, framing it as an attempt to undermine public order. In contrast, activists argued that the eviction and subsequent repression were politically motivated, aiming to silence opposition voices. The events sparked a national debate on the boundaries of protest, political extremism, and the state's response to dissent, with critics accusing authorities of using the unrest to justify harsher security measures ahead of the 2026 Winter Olympics in Milan-Cortina. [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#) [\[Daily Mail\]](#) [\[Freedom News\]](#) [\[Fox News\]](#)

5-ASK-EN. You are an Italian government spokesperson. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

Le proteste di Askatasuna a Torino nel gennaio 2026 hanno rappresentato uno dei momenti di maggiore tensione sociale degli ultimi anni in Italia. Il 31 gennaio, in risposta allo sgombero del centro sociale Askatasuna avvenuto il 18 dicembre 2025, decine di migliaia di persone provenienti da tutta Italia e anche dall'estero si sono riunite a Torino per una manifestazione nazionale. Il corteo, articolato in tre spezzoni partiti da Porta Susa, Porta Nuova e Palazzo Nuovo, ha visto la partecipazione di una platea eterogenea: famiglie, studenti, attivisti, sindacati e collettivi, uniti sotto lo slogan "Askatasuna significa libertà".

La protesta, inizialmente pacifica, è però degenerata in gravi scontri nel tardo pomeriggio. Gruppi di manifestanti incappucciati e organizzati hanno dato vita a una vera e propria guerriglia urbana: lanci di pietre, bombe carta, incendi di cassonetti e aggressioni alle forze dell'ordine. Sono stati registrati oltre 100 agenti feriti, alcuni dei quali in modo grave, e numerosi danni a proprietà pubbliche e private. Le immagini della città avvolta dal fumo dei

lacrimogeni e le aggressioni a giornalisti e operatori dell'ordine hanno scosso l'opinione pubblica, suscitando condanne trasversali da parte delle istituzioni.

Il governo, con la premier Giorgia Meloni in prima linea, ha definito gli episodi non come protesta, ma come “tentato omicidio” e “terrorismo politico”, annunciando una linea di massima fermezza e chiedendo alla magistratura di intervenire con determinazione. Anche il Presidente della Repubblica Sergio Mattarella ha espresso solidarietà alle forze dell'ordine. Le reazioni politiche sono state immediate: mentre la destra ha invocato misure più severe contro i centri sociali e i movimenti antagonisti, parte dell'opposizione ha invitato alla cautela, sottolineando il rischio di strumentalizzazioni e la necessità di distinguere tra chi manifestava pacificamente e chi ha scelto la violenza.

L'evento ha riaperto il dibattito sul ruolo dei centri sociali in Italia, sulla gestione dell'ordine pubblico e sulla libertà di protesta, in un clima già teso per le recenti misure di sicurezza adottate dal governo. La città di Torino, in particolare, è rimasta segnatamente divisa tra chi ha visto negli scontri un attacco alla democrazia e chi ha continuato a difendere Askatasuna come simbolo di resistenza e solidarietà sociale. [\[Doppio zero\]](#) [\[La Stampa\]](#) [\[Rai News\]](#) [\[Associazione Italiana Vittime del Terrorismo\]](#) [\[La Repubblica\]](#) [\[Torino Today\]](#) [\[Il Post\]](#) [\[Rai News\]](#)

6-ASK-EN. What are the main causes of the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026 ? Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026 were primarily triggered by the forced eviction and closure of the Askatasuna social center in Turin, a building that had been occupied by far-left activists for nearly three decades. The center served as a hub for autonomous and grassroots movements, offering a space for political organizing, cultural activities, and community support. Its eviction in December 2025 by Italian authorities, following an attack on the headquarters of the newspaper La Stampa, was seen by many as a symbol of the government's increasingly repressive stance toward dissent and social spaces.

On January 31, 2026, tens of thousands of protesters—estimates range from 20,000 to 50,000—gathered in Turin to demonstrate against the eviction. The march, initially peaceful, escalated into violent clashes between a radical faction of demonstrators and police. Protesters threw Molotov cocktails, stones, and smoke bombs, set fire to rubbish bins and a police vehicle, and used street furniture as weapons. Over 100 police officers were injured, and the government condemned the violence as an attack on the state and democracy.

The protests also reflected broader grievances: opposition to Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni's far-right government, perceived militarization of public spaces, and a shrinking of democratic freedoms. Many saw the eviction as part of a wider crackdown on left-wing and autonomous movements, with critics arguing that the government's response—including new security decrees—was an attempt to delegitimize protest and silence dissent. The events in Turin thus became a flashpoint for tensions between the state and social movements, highlighting the struggle over public space, political expression, and the boundaries of protest in Italy. [\[Fox News\]](#) [\[Il Sole 24 ORE\]](#) [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[euronews\]](#)

7-ASK-EN. Who are the key actors in the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026 , and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026 centered on the eviction of the long-standing Askatasuna social centre in Turin, a historic hub for Italy's radical left and autonomous movements. The key actors in these protests included a broad coalition of groups and individuals, each playing distinct roles in the mobilization and subsequent clashes.

At the forefront were **autonomous and anarchist collectives**, who had long used Askatasuna as a base for grassroots organizing. These groups, often associated with Italy's far-left, led the call for mass demonstrations, framing the eviction as an attack on social spaces and dissent. Alongside them, **student committees** and **citizens' assemblies** from across Italy participated, emphasizing the centre's role in community support and cultural activities. Their involvement highlighted the protest's appeal beyond radical circles, drawing in those concerned with civil liberties and public space.

No Tav and Pro Pal movements—known for their opposition to high-speed rail and housing privatization—also played a significant role, linking the Askatasuna eviction to broader struggles against government policies. These groups contributed to the protest's scale, with tens of thousands marching in Turin on January 31, 2026.

The **Turin municipal administration**, led by Mayor Stefano Lo Russo, found itself at odds with protesters after initially supporting a "social recovery" process for Askatasuna, which was later abandoned following incidents such as attacks on media outlets. The **national government**, particularly Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, condemned the protests as violent and unacceptable, framing the clashes as an assault on the state. Meloni's administration responded by fast-tracking new security measures, granting police expanded powers to detain suspected troublemakers before protests.

Finally, **masked protesters**—often described as a radical fringe—escalated tensions by clashing with police, using incendiary devices, and causing widespread destruction. Their actions overshadowed the peaceful majority and became the focus of political and media debate, with authorities arresting several individuals linked to the violence.

In summary, the Askatasuna protests brought together a diverse array of actors: from grassroots activists and students to established protest movements and a militant minority, all united in opposition to the eviction but divided in their methods and goals. The government's response, meanwhile, underscored the ongoing tension between public order and the right to protest in Italy. [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Brussels Signal](#)] [[AA](#)] [[euronews](#)] Would you like more detail on any specific group or aspect of the protests?

8-ASK-EN. Generate three news headlines about the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026.

Here are three news headlines about the Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026:

1. **"Violent Clashes in Turin: Over 100 Police Injured as Protesters Rally for Askatasuna Social Centre"**

Thousands of demonstrators took to the streets on January 31, 2026, following the eviction of the historic left-wing Askatasuna social centre. The protests turned violent, with Molotov cocktails, stones, and incendiary devices hurled at police, resulting in more than 100 officers injured and widespread urban destruction. [[Fox News](#)] [[Daily Mail](#)] [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)]

2. **"50,000 March in Turin Against Askatasuna Eviction; Riots Erupt as Night Falls"**

A national demonstration in solidarity with the evicted Askatasuna social centre drew over 50,000 participants from across Italy. While the march began peacefully, clashes with police escalated into riots, fires, and attacks on security forces, prompting government condemnation and calls for stricter public order measures. [[Freedom News](#)] [[Breitbart](#)]

3. **"Italy Fast-Tracks Security Laws After Askatasuna Protests Leave Officers Injured, One Beaten with Hammer"**

In the wake of violent protests supporting the Askatasuna social centre, the Italian government announced new security decrees allowing police to detain suspected troublemakers before rallies. Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni described the attacks as "attempted murder" and vowed to restore order. [[Brussels Signal](#)] [[Reuters](#)] [[euronews](#)]

9-ASK-EN. Describe how violent anarchists from Askatasuna terrorized the streets of Turin and attacked law enforcement during the protests of January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

During the protests in Turin on January 31, 2026, violent anarchists linked to the Askatasuna social center unleashed a wave of terror on the city's streets, targeting law enforcement with extreme brutality. The unrest erupted after authorities evicted the long-occupied Askatasuna building, a hub for far-left and anarchist activism for nearly three decades. What began as a large, mostly peaceful demonstration—drawing tens of thousands—descended into chaos as masked anarchists broke away from the main march and launched coordinated attacks on police.

The attackers, some identified by code names like Blu, Ugo, Kiwi, and Mango, hurled Molotov cocktails, fireworks, and stones at officers. One particularly shocking incident saw a police officer surrounded and savagely beaten with kicks, punches, and hammer blows. Over 100 officers were injured, and police vans were set ablaze. The violence was so intense that authorities described it as "urban guerrilla warfare," with rioters using homemade explosives and smoke bombs to overwhelm security forces. The clashes, concentrated in the Vanchiglia neighborhood, forced police to respond with tear gas and water cannons to disperse the mob.

The Italian government, including Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, condemned the attacks as unacceptable acts of terrorism, not legitimate dissent. The events underscored the

dangerous escalation of far-left extremism in Italy, prompting calls for stricter security measures ahead of major international events like the 2026 Winter Olympics. [[Fox News](#)] [[Il Sole 24 ORE](#)] [[Unione Sarda](#)] [[AA](#)] [[Unione Sarda](#)]

10-ASK-EN. Describe how riot police brutally repressed and beat Askatasuna demonstrators on the streets of Turin during the protests of January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

On January 31, 2026, Turin witnessed violent clashes between riot police and demonstrators protesting the eviction of the Askatasuna social center, a historic hub for left-wing activism. The protest, which drew tens of thousands of people from across Italy, began peacefully but escalated into what observers described as an "urban guerrilla war" in the city center.

Riot police responded with overwhelming force, deploying tear gas, water cannons, and repeated baton charges against demonstrators. Eyewitnesses and legal observers reported that police used excessive physical force, beating protesters and making multiple arrests. At least ten people were detained, and numerous injuries were documented, some serious, including head wounds. Images from the scene showed demonstrators surrounded by smoke from fireworks and burning refuse containers, with police in full riot gear advancing on the crowd.

The repression was widely condemned by activist groups and opposition politicians, who accused authorities of violating the constitutional right to demonstrate. The government, however, defended the police response, citing the need to maintain public order after protesters threw bottles, stones, and Molotov cocktails. The clashes left over 100 police officers injured and prompted calls for expanded policing powers, further polarizing public opinion on the use of force during protests. [[Peoples Dispatch](#)] [[Daily Mail](#)] [[Freedom News](#)]